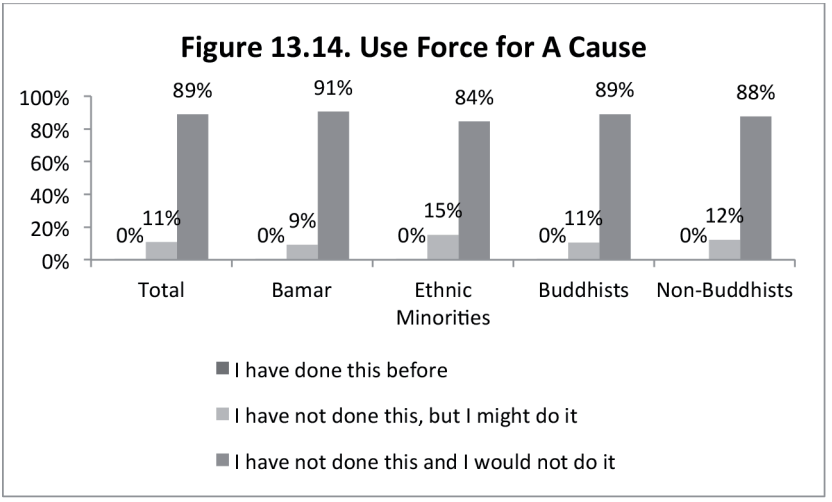


REFLECTIONS AND CONCLUSIONS

Each of these frames of difference — ethnicity, religion, and minorities — point to a similar implication, the need for political change. There is considerable agreement found in the ABS across cleavages on this need for reform, be it for decentralizing authority, strengthening the economy, supporting more inclusive governance and democracy, or systemic change without violence. This similarity bodes well for future trajectories surrounding conflict, as there is broad support reported for measures that have the potential to reduce conflict and public support for reform within the system. The key will be whether the military and elites, including those from the NLD, will be able to build on this public support. Often in analyses of conflict in Myanmar, bringing the public in through measures such as elections is seen to be at odds with reducing conflict. The focus on reducing conflict has rested with the elites in the system, who are seen to use negotiation to resolve differences and reach peace accords. While not dismissing the importance of elite dialogue and discussion as a critical component of reducing conflict in Myanmar, the ABS findings suggest that more confidence should be placed in Myanmar citizens in their understanding and support for measures that reduce conflict. The ABS shows that a majority of Myanmar citizens across cleavages support